Inglés I

Grammar

Present Perfect Tense



Have a look at this comic.



What does it mean?
What is the verb tense used? What do you know about it?

The **present perfect** is formed from the present tense of the verb ***have*** and the **past participle** of a verb.

We use the present perfect:

- afor something that **started in the past** and **continues in the present**:

*They**'ve been married** for nearly fifty years.*
*She **has lived** in Liverpool all her life.*

- when we are talking about our **experience up to the present**:

*I**'ve seen** that film before.*
*I**'ve played** the guitar ever since I was a teenager.*
*He **has written** three books and he is working on another one.*

We often use the adverb ***ever*** to talk about experience up to the present:

*My last birthday was the worst day I **have ever had**.*

And we use ***never*** for the negative form:

***Have** you **ever met** George?*
*Yes, but I**'ve never met** his wife.*

Grammar reference: Present perfect 1

Complete the sentences with the present perfect of the verbs in brackets ( ). Remember that the adverbs 'ever' and 'never' go AFTER 'have/has' and BEFORE the past participle.

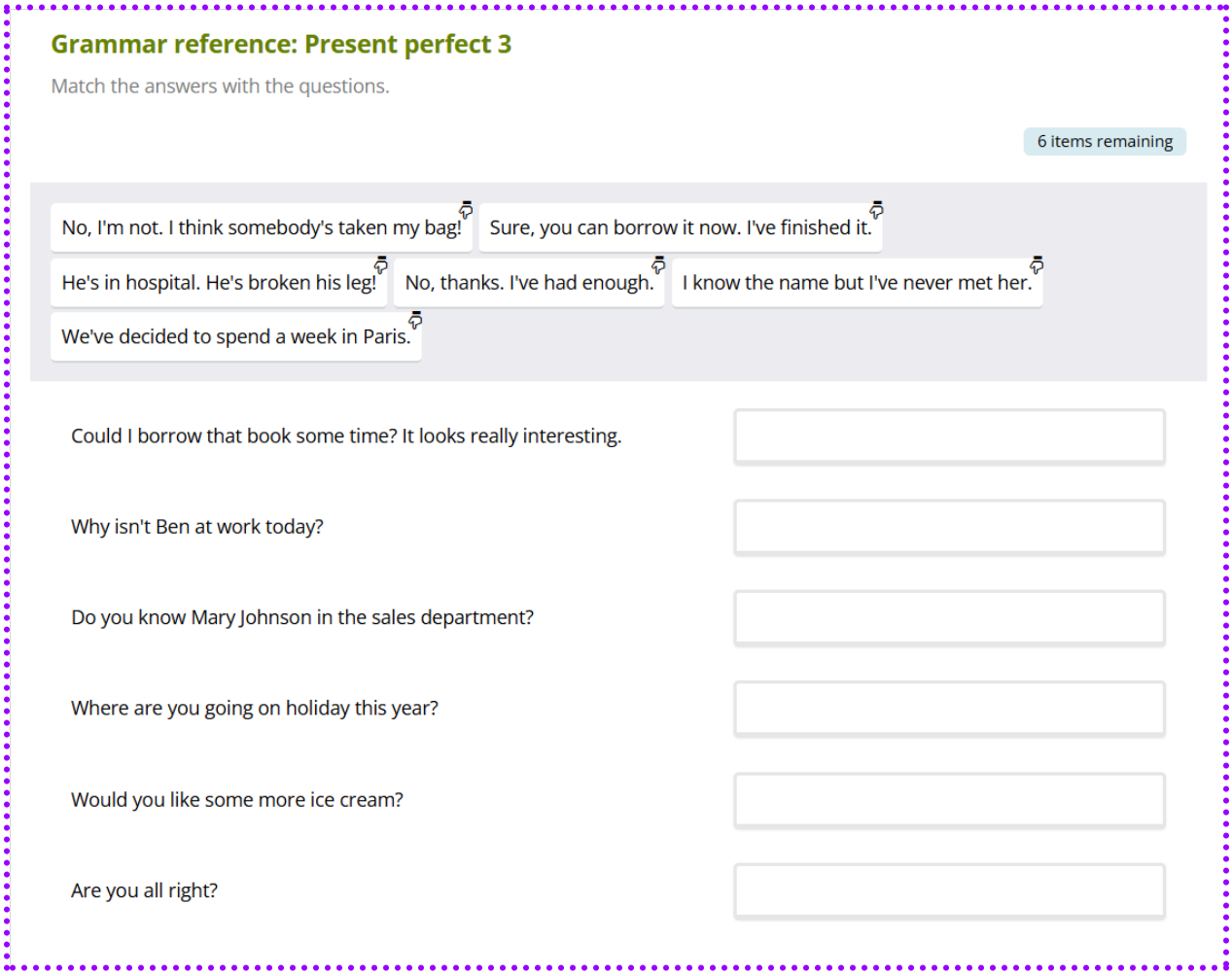
10 items remaining

1. Sophie and I (know) _____ each other since we were at school together.
2. I (play) _____ tennis since I was eight years old.
3. Alain (be) _____ in hospital three times this year.
4. I (want) _____ to be an actor for as long as I can remember.
5. My uncle (smoke) _____ 40 cigarettes a day for 40 years – and he's a doctor!
6. You (have) _____ that suit for more than ten years! Isn't it time to get a new one?
7. Since he finished university, my brother (work) _____ in five different countries.
8. Zerrin (watch) _____ that TV programme every week since it started.
9. I (never like) _____ bananas. I think they're horrible!
10. What's the most interesting city you (ever visit) _____ ?

https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar/english-grammar-reference/present-perfect#

- for something that **happened in the past** but is **important in the present**:

*I can't get in the house. I **'ve lost** my keys.*
*Teresa isn't at home. I think she **has gone** shopping.*



(You can do this activity on the same link above)

have been* and *have gone

We use ***have/has been*** when someone has ***gone*** to a place and ***returned***:

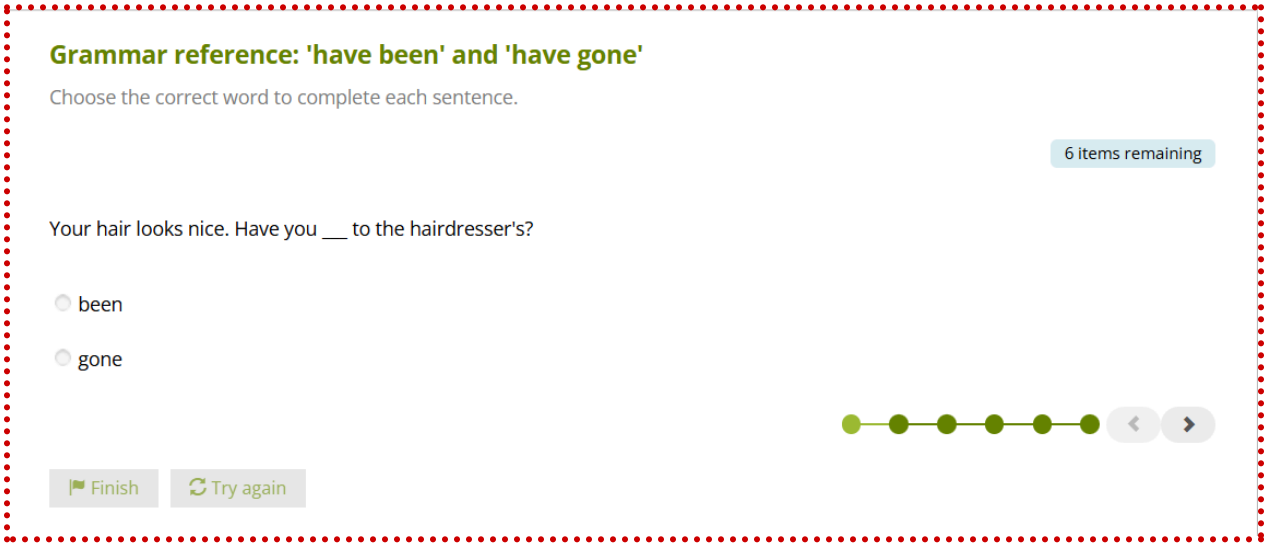
*A: Where **have** you **been**?*
*B: I**'ve** just **been** out **to** the supermarket.*

*A: **Have** you **ever been to** San Francisco?*
*B: No, but I'**ve been to** Los Angeles.*

But when someone **has not returned**, we use ***have/has gone***:

A: Where's Maria? I haven't seen her for weeks.
*B: She'**s gone to** Paris for a week. She'll be back tomorrow.*

https://wordwall.net/es/resource/3674594/present-perfect-been-gone



(See activity on previous link)

Present perfect with time adverbials

We often use the present perfect with adverbials **which refer to the recent past**:

recently	*just*	*only just*

*Scientists **have recently discovered** a new breed of monkey.*
*We **have just got** back from our holidays.*

or **adverbials which include the present**:

so far *until now* *up to now*

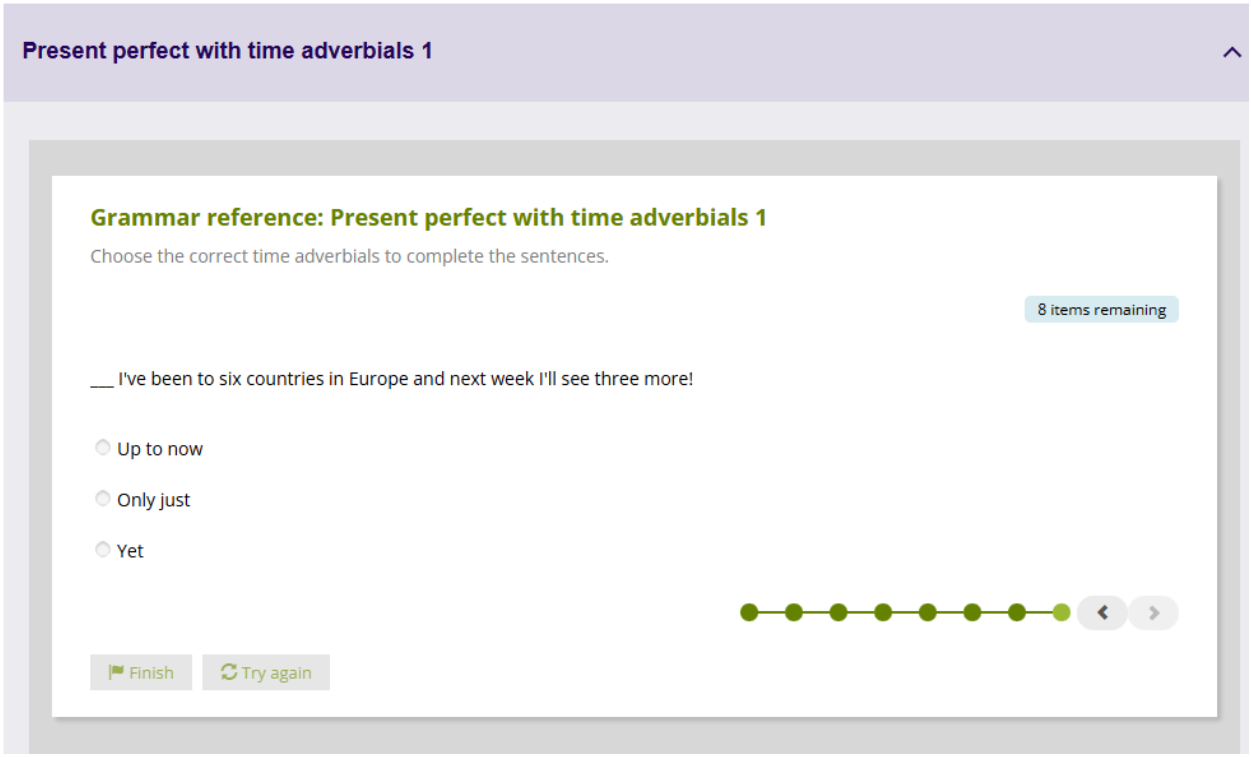
ever (in questions)

yet (in questions and negatives)

***Have** you **ever** **seen** a ghost?*
*Where **have** you **been** **up to now**?*
*A: **Have** you **finished** your homework **yet**?*
*B: No, **so far** I'**ve** only **done** my history.*

After a clause with the present perfect we often use **a clause with *since* to show when something started in the past**:

*I'**ve worked** here **since I left school**.*
*I'**ve been watching** that programme every week **since it started**.*



(Same link: https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar/english-grammar-reference/present-perfect)

Be careful!

We do not use the present perfect with adverbials which refer to a finished past time:

yesterday	*last week/ last month / last year*	*in 2017*	*when I was younger*	etc.

*I **have seen** that film **~~yesterday~~**.*
*We **have** just **bought** a new car **~~last week~~**.*
***~~When we were children~~** we **have been** to California.*

but we can use the present perfect with **adverbials which refer to a time which is not yet finished**:

today	*this week/month/year*	*now that I am 18*	etc.

***Have** you **seen** Helen **today**?*
*We **have bought** a new car **this week**.*

Source:
https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar/english-grammar-reference/present-perfect

Time to play!
https://www.baamboozle.com/classic/331614
https://wordwall.net/es/resource/36282450/ingl%c3%a9s/present-perfect-put-sentences-in-order
https://wordwall.net/es/resource/25966420/hit-the-past-participles

Extra Practice:

https://english-practice.net/english-grammar-exercises-for-a2-present-perfect/